



The Future of Leading Design in an **Agentic World**



— **RECAP** MIAMI · 24-25 SEP 2026

THE INFLECTION POINT

DDX'26 Miami. 19 design and product leaders, one question: if every competitor runs on the same AI, what makes yours worth choosing?

— THE DAYS

Two days.
Two venues.
One question.

19

SPEAKERS

7

TALKS & KEYNOTES

3

PANELS

6

TABLE TALKS

— THE ROOM

Thank you, Miami.



Personal isn't human. Difference is the value.

AI makes every service individually better and collectively the same. When sameness is cheap, difference lives in interaction, in the tensions a company chooses to hold, and in the room it leaves for a person.



Meghan Preiss, Universal · Jonathan Montalvo, Plei · Shaivi Ganatra, Viveka Health · Anastasiia Leliakova, Vegas Creative

CITED ON STAGE

85%

would rather talk to a real person than to AI when contacting a business.

AnswerConnect / OnePoll, May 2026



Meghan Preiss: "Personal Isn't Human"

Feel it. Design belongs closer to the decision.

Feels, reason and data all lead to product decisions. A design team that only brings data is not in the room where the call is made, and in agentic products the question becomes who is allowed to say yes.



Cassie McDaniel, Medium · Monica Girel, Adobe · Gleb Kuznetsov, Brain Technologies · Sebastian Gier, DDX

2026 EVIDENCE

72%

of CEOs now say they are the main AI decision-maker in their company, double the prior year.

BCG, AI Radar 2026



Cassie McDaniel: you can make decisions without data

Six months with an agent. **Detach, focus, align, delegate, audit.**

Sures Kumar gave an agent his calendar, fifteen years of email, his finances and his lab results. Every failure fell into one of three buckets: missing context, information that can't be captured, or bad reasoning with everything in hand.



Sures Kumar, Google DeepMind · Gleb Kuznetsov, Brain Technologies · Abhilash Kolapareddy, Citi · Coral Miniell, fixurfeed

2026 EVIDENCE

32%

of US AI users have already let an agent act on their behalf without approval.

Menlo Ventures, State of Consumer AI, Sep 2026



The best design system is one **AI can't forget to use.**

Design systems are turning from documentation into living infrastructure that humans and AI both read, so generative tools inherit a company's design language by default. The designers who win orchestrate context and taste.



Ivan Barriga, FlavorCloud · Jonathan Ruiz, Docusign ·
Dianne Alter, The Design Project · Raul Justiniano,
Asurion

2026 EVIDENCE

1 in 2

designers have already shipped AI-generated code to production.

Designer Fund & Foundation Capital, AI in Design 2026



Table talks ran through the whole day

Research at the scale of the business, judgment in the loop.

One researcher, 200,000 open-ended responses a quarter and an AI-assisted synthesis pipeline, with a human check for the costly failure: feedback that sounds identical but points to different root causes.



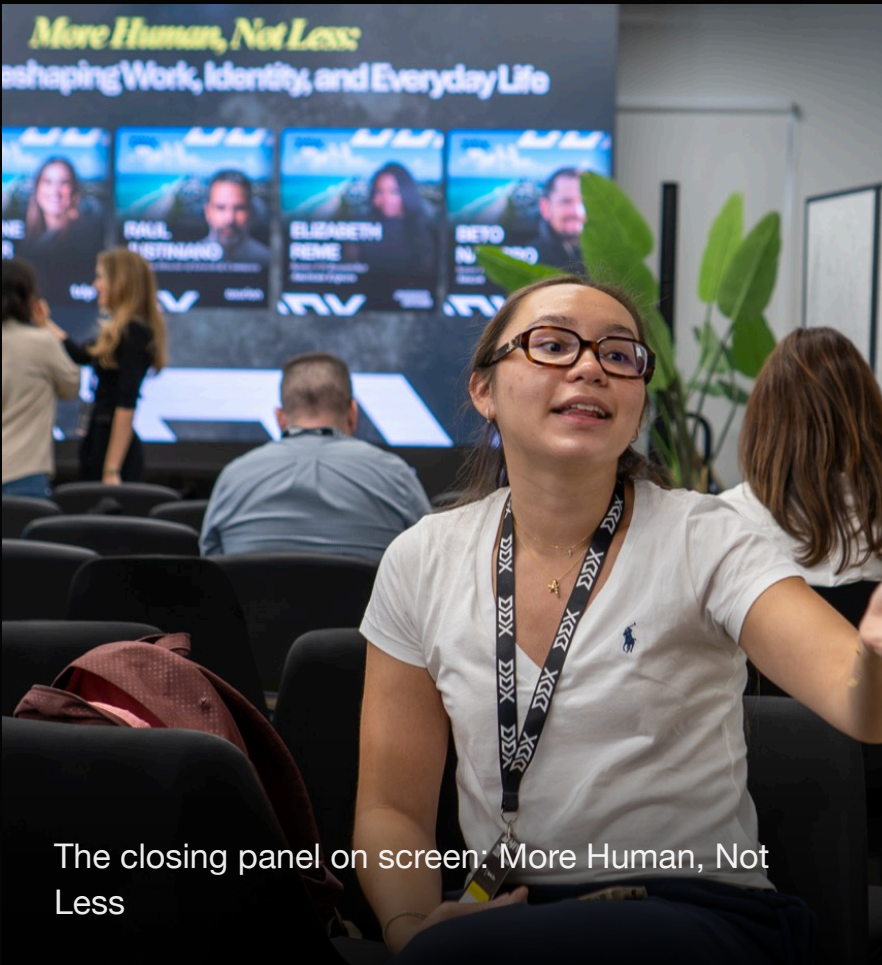
Elizabeth Reme, American Express · Liz Steelman, Askable · Beto Navarro, Amazon · Friends of Figma Miami

STILL HUMAN

82%

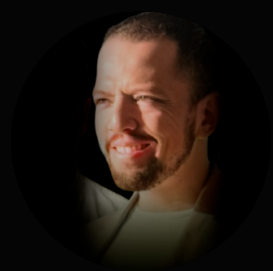
of research practitioners say interpreting nuance and emotion remains a job for humans.

Maze, Future of User Research 2026



The closing panel on screen: More Human, Not Less

“The most exciting thing about this moment in design isn’t the technology — it’s that AI is forcing us to go back to first principles. The designers who thrive will be the ones who know why something should exist, not just how to make it.”



Beto Navarro

Senior Product Designer, Amazon · Founder, Friends of Figma Miami

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MIAMI



Same exchange, next city.

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12 Feb 2027

MIAMI '27

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